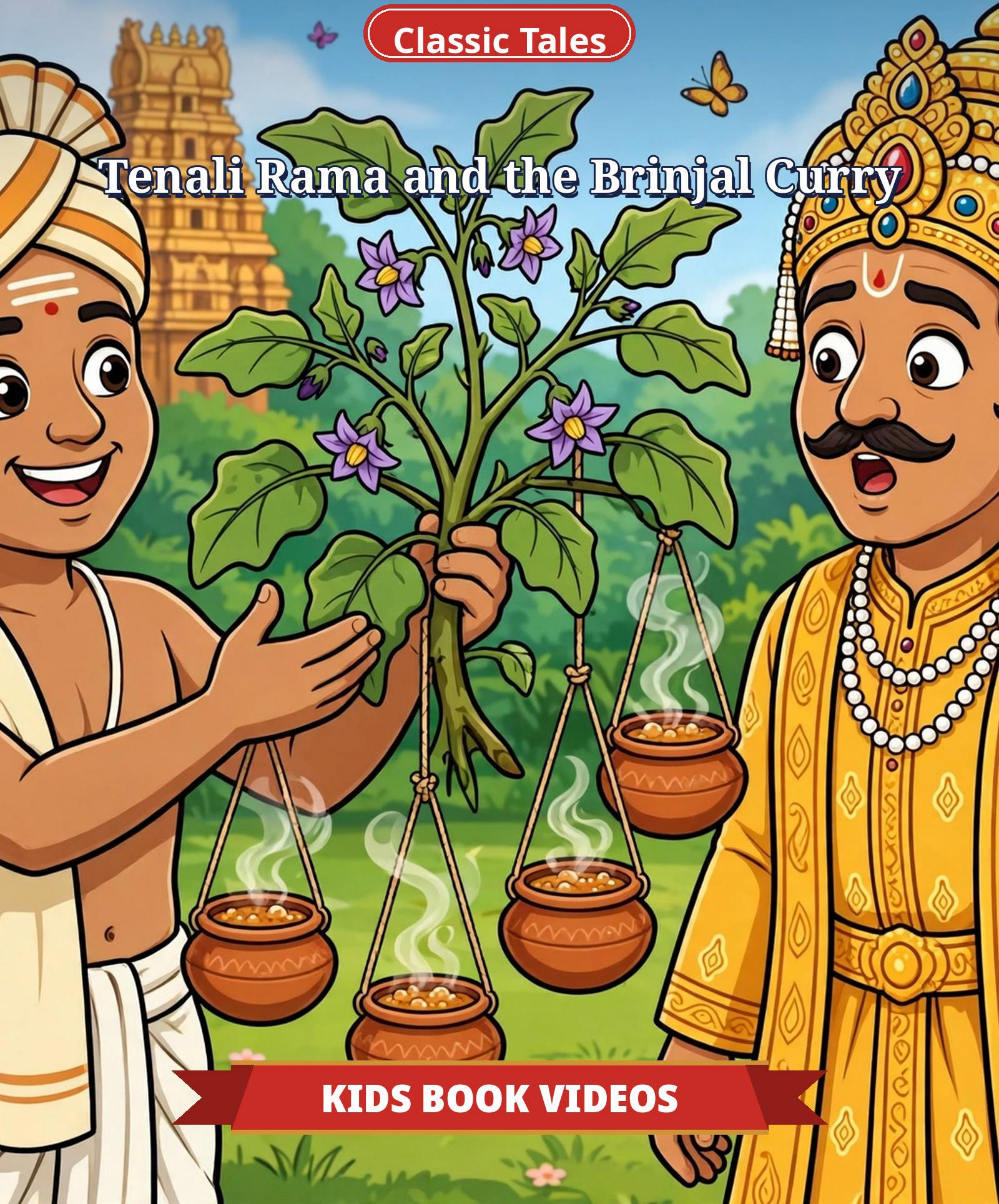


Classic Tales

Tenali Rama and the Brinjal Curry



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



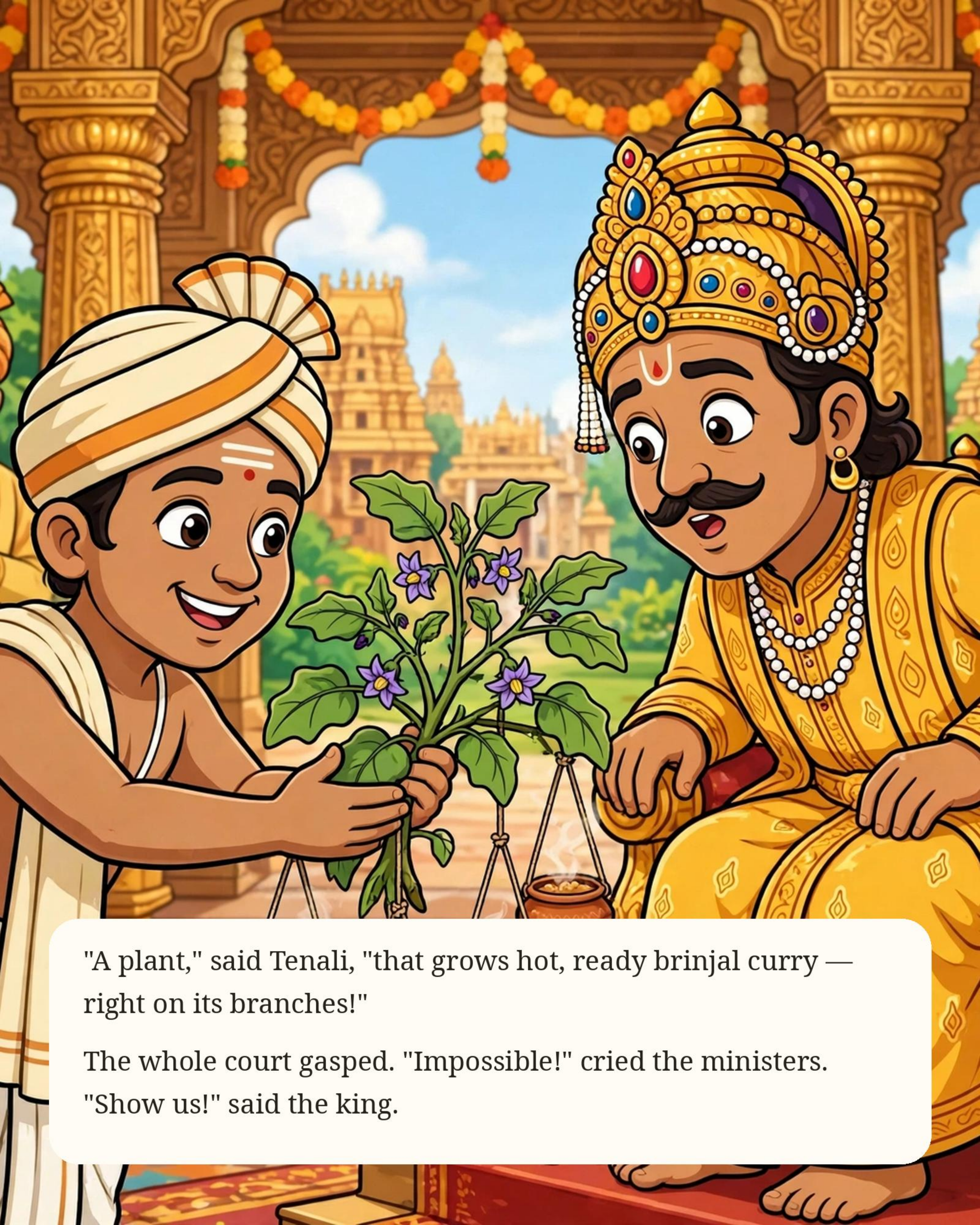
In the grand kingdom of Vijayanagara lived a wise king, and his cleverest courtier was Tenali Rama.

The king loved brinjal curry more than anything. "No one cooks it better than my royal cook!" he boasted one day.



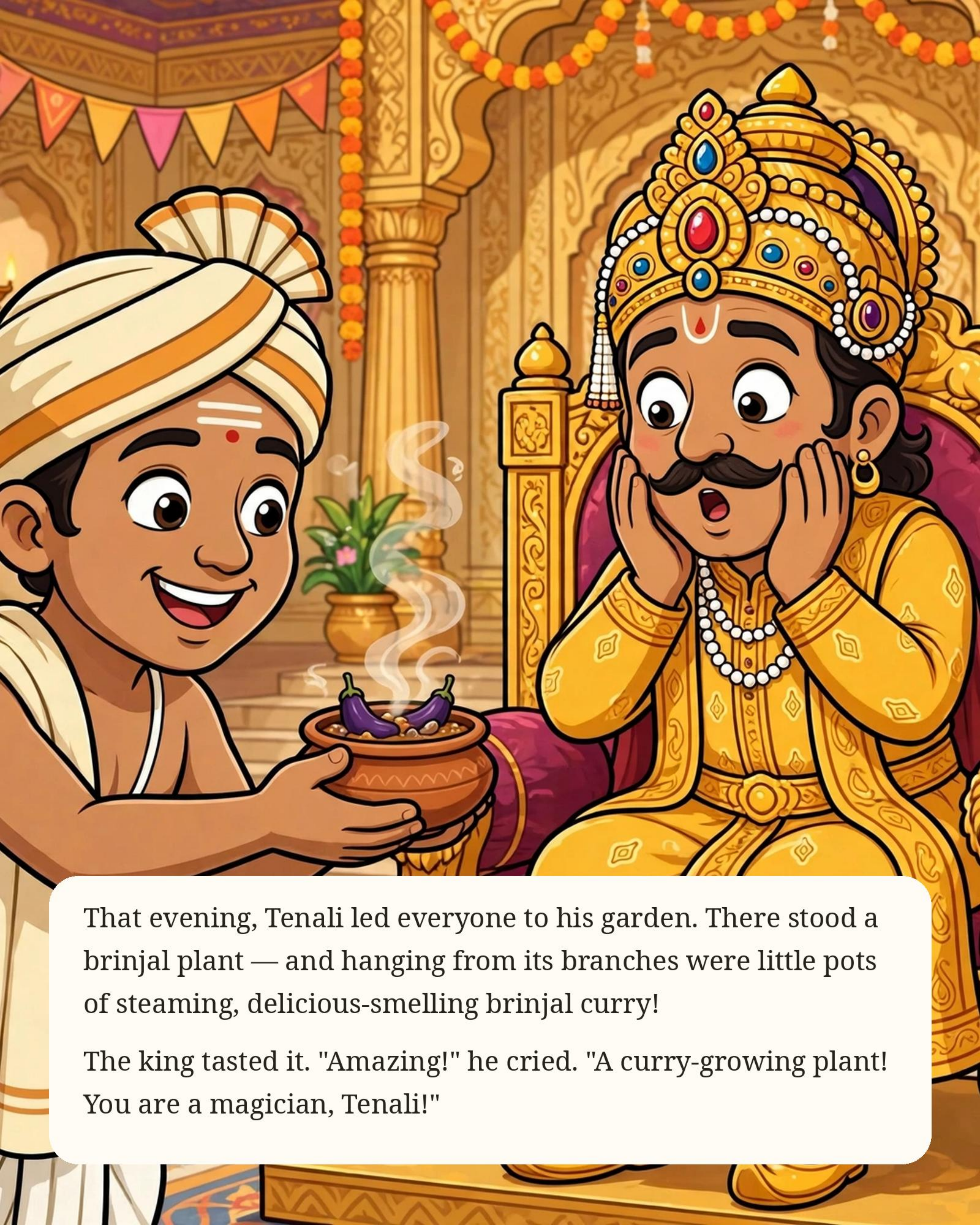
Tenali Rama smiled. "Your Majesty, I have grown something even more wonderful in my garden."

"What could be more wonderful than my cook's curry?" laughed the king.



"A plant," said Tenali, "that grows hot, ready brinjal curry — right on its branches!"

The whole court gasped. "Impossible!" cried the ministers.
"Show us!" said the king.

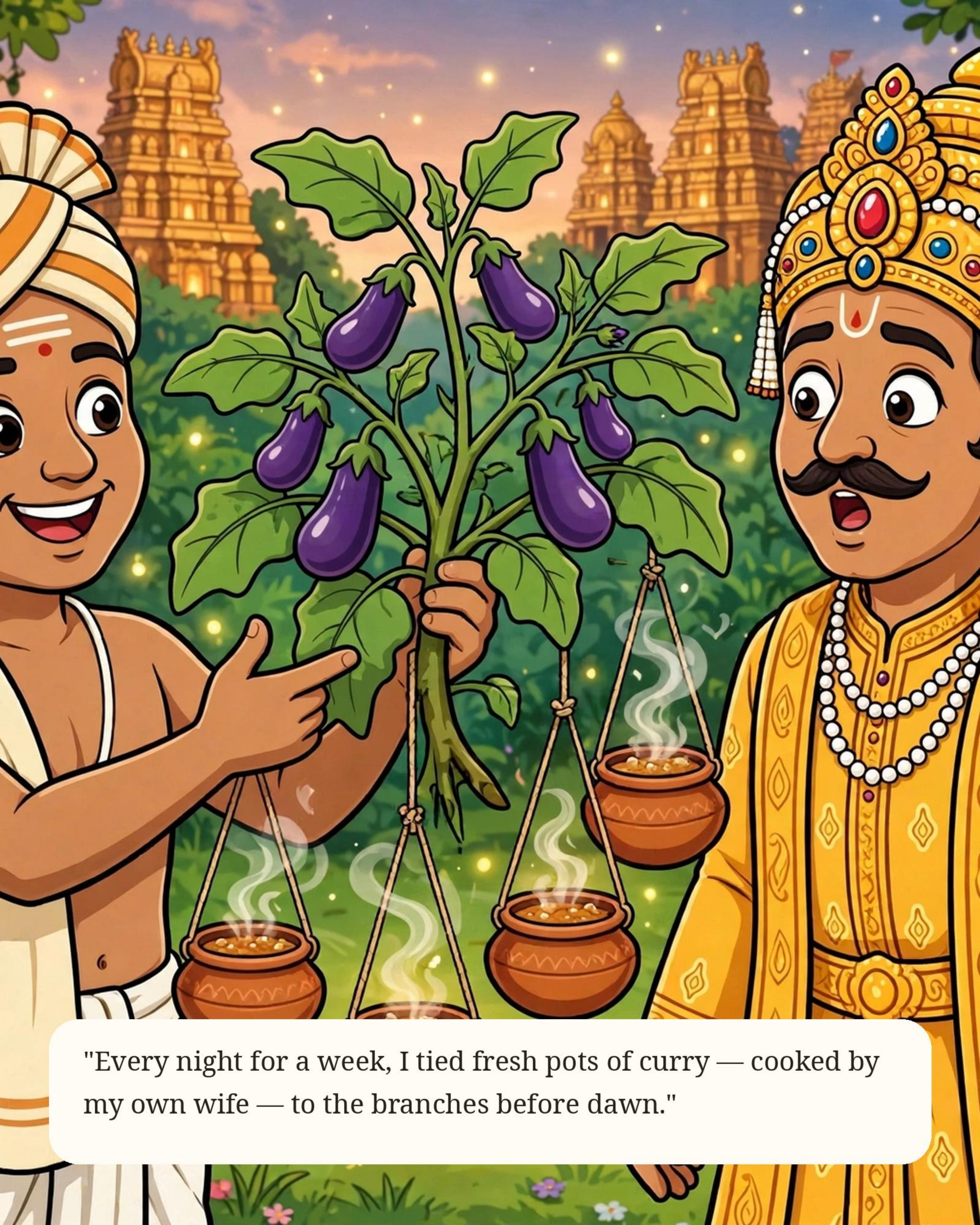


That evening, Tenali led everyone to his garden. There stood a brinjal plant — and hanging from its branches were little pots of steaming, delicious-smelling brinjal curry!

The king tasted it. "Amazing!" he cried. "A curry-growing plant! You are a magician, Tenali!"



Tenali Rama bowed low, trying not to laugh. "Your Majesty, shall I tell you the secret?"



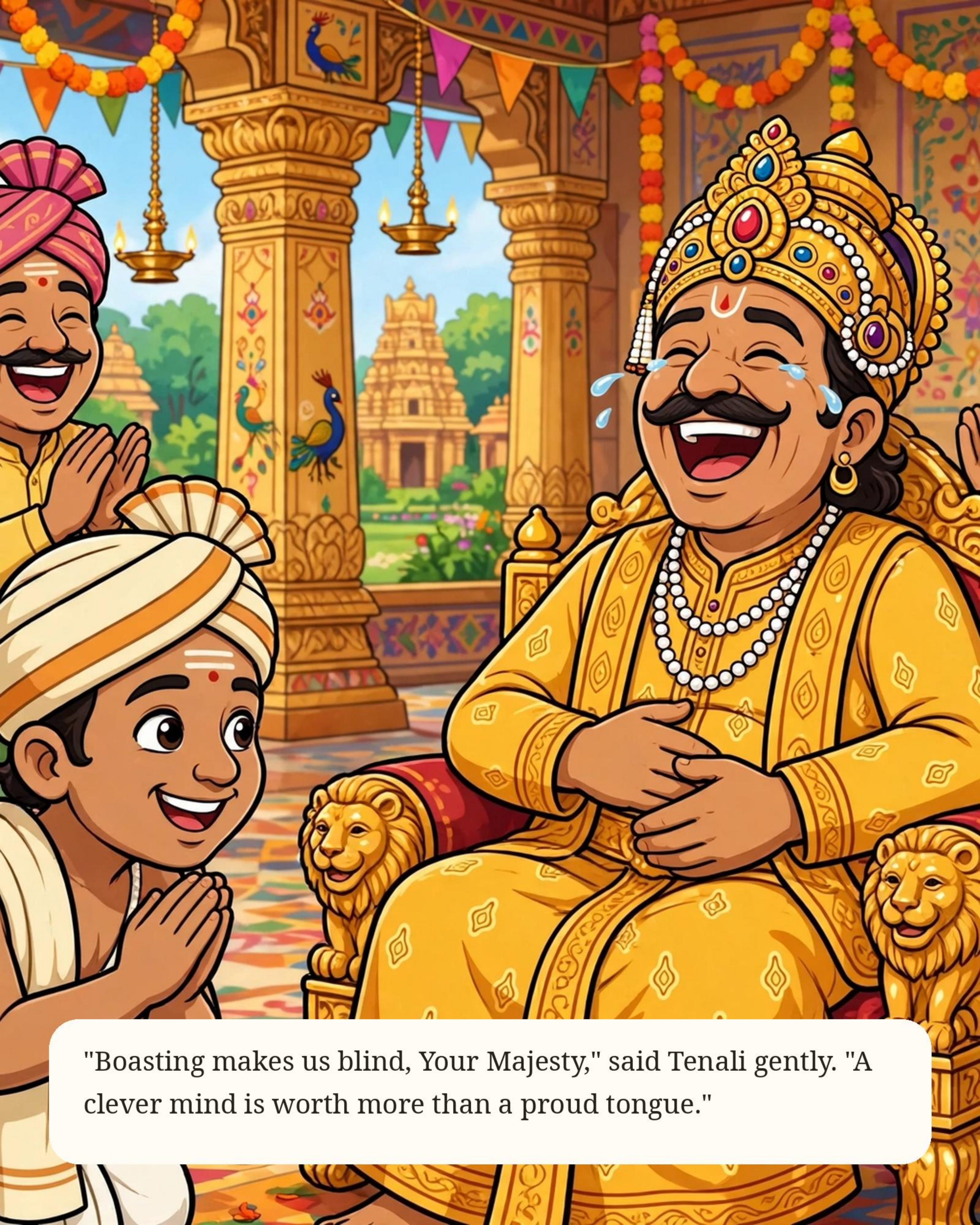
"Every night for a week, I tied fresh pots of curry — cooked by my own wife — to the branches before dawn."



The court roared with laughter. The king laughed loudest of all.



"You fooled us all!" said the king. "But I am not angry. You have taught me something."



"Boasting makes us blind, Your Majesty," said Tenali gently. "A clever mind is worth more than a proud tongue."



From that day, the king boasted a little less — and laughed a little more.

Wit is stronger than pride.

The End

